

Competitor Intelligence Framework.

The complete competitor intelligence system — how Auxion discovers a real competitive set, scores it, compares it dimension by dimension, and turns the gaps into evidence-backed threats and opportunities. Every comparison inherits the AIS-001 evidence states and the AIS-003 mathematics. The two hard rules govern everything below: *never fabricate a competitor, never fabricate a benchmark*. A competitor that cannot be evidenced is reported Unavailable, not invented.

EVIDENCE-BACKED11 DIMENSIONSSIMILARITY MATHNO FABRICATIONSWOT + LEADERSHIP

TWO INVIOABLE RULES

1 · Never fabricate a competitor — the set is discovered from evidence, and a rival that fails the evidence threshold is dropped or marked Unavailable. 2 · Never fabricate a benchmark — every comparison figure traces to an observed or defensibly-estimated source, carried with its state and confidence.

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01 WHY COMPETITOR INTELLIGENCE

WHY BEFORE HOW

Why a business is judged against its market

A score in isolation is meaningless — a 60 on digital presence is strong in one industry and weak in another. Competitor intelligence is what makes every Auxion finding relative and therefore actionable: the client is measured against the businesses actually contesting the same customers.

Why fabrication is the cardinal sin

A single invented competitor or made-up benchmark discredits the entire report and the platform behind it. Because these numbers are shown to clients as fact and used to justify spend, the framework is built first around what it refuses to do — assert a rival or a figure it cannot evidence.

Why like-for-like is non-negotiable

Comparing the client’s observed data against a competitor’s guessed data produces a confident lie. The framework scores every party on the same dimensions with the same evidence rules and carries each cell’s state, so a comparison is never stronger than its weaker side.

02 DISCOVERY, RELEVANCE & SELECTION

CANDIDATE → SET

The engine builds a candidate pool from evidence, scores each candidate’s relevance across several axes, and admits only those above threshold. Relevance is multi-dimensional — a business can be a rival on geography but not on segment.

Competitor discovery

Build a candidate pool from market signals, category, observed positioning, customer-overlap traces, and referenced rivals in the evidence.

Industry classification

Classify the client and each candidate into a category taxonomy so comparison happens within the right market.

Geographic relevance

Weight candidates by the overlap of their served geography with the client’s, since a distant rival competes less.

Market segmentation

Match on segment — a premium and a budget player in one category are only partial competitors.

Customer overlap

Estimate shared audience from evidence; higher overlap means a more direct competitor.

Selection threshold

Admit only candidates whose relevance and evidence clear the threshold; the rest are dropped, not shown.

Set sizing

Cap the set to the most relevant N so comparison stays meaningful, and record why each was included.

03 SIMILARITY SCORING & RANKING MATHEMATICS

SIM(c)

SIMILARITY SCORE

$$\text{Sim}(c) = \sum_k w_k \cdot \text{sim}_k(\text{client}, c)$$

A weighted blend of per-axis similarity — industry, geography, segment, customer overlap, offering. Industry weighting is set per category, so relevance means the right thing for each market.

RELEVANCE RANK

$$\text{Rank}(c) = \text{Sim}(c) \cdot C(c)$$

Similarity scaled by the confidence in that competitor's evidence. A poorly-evidenced but seemingly-similar rival ranks below a well-evidenced clear one.

Per-axis similarity

Each axis — industry, geography, segment, overlap, offering — yields its own similarity in [0,1] before weighting.

Industry weighting

Axis weights vary by category; in a local-services market geography dominates, in SaaS the offering does.

Confidence scaling

Rank multiplies similarity by evidence confidence, so a well-evidenced rival outranks a speculative one.

04 COMPARISON DIMENSIONS

11 DIMENSIONS · 4 STATES

Client and competitors are scored on the same eleven dimensions using the same evidence rules, so every comparison is like-for-like. Each cell carries its evidence state — a comparison is only as honest as the weaker of the two sides' evidence.

● Observed · directly measured ● Estimated · modeled from data ● Inferred · reasoned, not seen

● Unavailable · not accessible

Brand positioning

Identity, tone, and perceived position relative to each rival.

SEO comparison

Indexability, keyword surface, and search visibility side by side.

Technology comparison

Observable stack, performance, and technical maturity.

Social comparison

Presence, activity, and audience signal across platforms.

Advertising comparison	Observable paid presence and channel mix where evidenced.	Content comparison	Depth, freshness, and coverage of content against rivals.
Automation comparison	Evidence of automated capture, response, and operations.	Customer experience	Journey quality, friction, and conversion paths compared.
Pricing comparison	Observable pricing posture and packaging where public.	Review analysis	Volume, rating, and sentiment across review platforms.
Performance benchmarking	Speed, reliability, and technical performance versus the set.		

05 BENCHMARKING, EVIDENCE & CONFIDENCE

NO FABRICATED NUMBERS

RELATIVE POSITION

$$\text{Position}_k = (\text{client}_k - \text{benchmark}_k) / \sigma_k$$

Each dimension is expressed as standardized distance from the competitive benchmark, so lead and lag are comparable across dimensions. The benchmark is the evidenced set's distribution — never a made-up target.

Evidence requirements	Every competitor dimension needs a source; without one the cell is Unavailable, never filled by analogy.	Benchmark from the set	The benchmark is the evidenced set's own distribution — a real percentile, not an aspirational target.
Confidence per cell	Each comparison cell carries its own confidence from the weaker side's evidence.	State propagation	A cell's evidence state (O/E/I/U) is shown in the report so the reader knows how firm each comparison is.

Normalization

Dimensions are standardized before comparison so no unit dominates by scale.

Coverage reporting

The share of dimensions actually evidenced for each competitor is reported alongside the comparison.

06 INTEGRITY CONTROLS

THE TWO RULES, ENFORCED

The two inviolable rules are enforced by explicit controls, not good intentions. False positives are filtered out; missing competitors and benchmarks are declared rather than filled.

False-positive prevention

A candidate below the relevance or evidence threshold is removed — the grid is never padded to look complete.

Missing-competitor handling

A known rival that cannot be scanned is listed as Unavailable with the reason, never estimated into the set.

Missing-benchmark handling

A dimension without evidence for a competitor is left Unavailable rather than back-filled from the client or an average.

Fabrication guard

The Validator rejects any competitor or benchmark lacking a source trace before it can reach the report.

Explainability

Every inclusion, exclusion, and score exposes the evidence and reasoning behind it, inspectable end to end.

Human review

The operator confirms the set before it is shown to a client, with the option to exclude a mis-identified rival.

07 GAP, THREAT, SWOT & LEADERSHIP

DERIVED OUTPUTS

The comparison produces the client-facing outputs — every gap, threat, and SWOT quadrant is derived from the dimension scores, never authored free-hand.

Strengths

$LEAD \geq +\sigma$

Dimensions where the client is defensibly ahead of the set, worth protecting.

Weaknesses

$LAG \leq -\sigma$

Dimensions where the client trails, each linked to the gap and a candidate move.

Opportunities

$GAP \times REACH$

Open gaps against rivals the client can realistically capture.

Threats

$RIVAL \ LEAD$

Competitor advantages actively endangering the client's position.

Opportunity gap analysis

Each dimension where the client trails becomes a sized, evidence-linked opportunity via the AIS-003 model.

Threat analysis

Each dimension where a rival leads becomes a scored threat with its exposure path in the graph.

Differentiation

Dimensions where the client uniquely leads are isolated as defensible differentiators.

MARKET LEADERSHIP SCORE

$$Lead = \sum_k w_k \cdot percentile_k(client \mid set)$$

The client's weighted percentile across dimensions within the evidenced set — a single 0-100 read of competitive standing, carried with the set's coverage so its reliability is visible.

08 CONTINUOUS UPDATES & CHANGE DETECTION

TEMPORAL

The competitive set is re-scanned on cadence. The engine tracks how the set and each dimension move over time, so the client sees trajectory, not just a snapshot.

Continuous updates

The set is re-discovered and re-scored on cadence; new entrants appear and faded rivals drop with evidence.

Historical comparisons

Prior competitive snapshots are retained so the client sees movement, not just the latest state.

Change detection

Diff each dimension against the prior scan to isolate what actually shifted in the market.

Trend analysis

Track each competitor and the client's relative position over time to reveal direction.

Entrant / exit detection

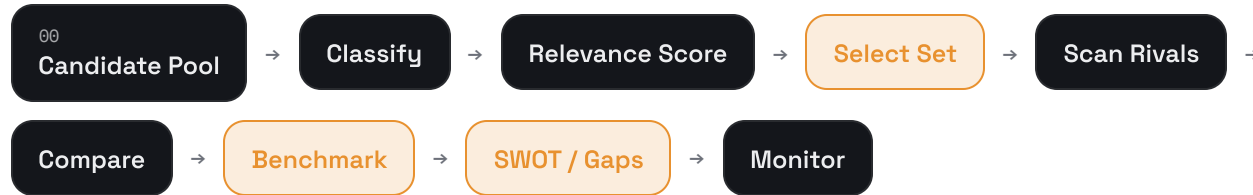
Flag when a new competitor crosses the relevance threshold or an existing one falls below it.

Alerting

Raise a prioritized signal when a rival move materially changes the client's standing.

A COMPETITOR INTELLIGENCE PIPELINE

DISCOVER → MONITOR



B LIFECYCLE DIAGRAMS

3 FLOWS

L1 Discovery lifecycle

Signals → Candidates → Classify → Score → Threshold → Set

L2 Comparison lifecycle

Scan rivals → Score dims → Benchmark → Position → Gaps / SWOT

L3 Update lifecycle

Re-scan → Diff → Detect entrant/exit → Trend → Alert